CERNO GLOBUS

FIELD INTELLIGENCE

Issue 007 Monday, November 9, 2026 · Biweekly, 4 pages

Automotive Services

Collision Repair · General Auto Repair · Tire & Wheel · Auto Glass · Towing & Roadside · Car Wash & Detailing

Six trades, one publication. Every item is something that moves a number on your P&L, changes what you must do by law, or changes what parts and labor cost you.

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BACKGROUND SIGNAL
The fraud that reads your invoices before it sends one

Read it online
This issue, and every one before it

RULE

NHTSA's October 27 notice would convene up to 18 stakeholders to rewrite its tire strength, bead-unseating and endurance tests, with comments and applications due about November 27.

NHTSA's notice of intent, dated October 27, 2026 (docket NHTSA-2026-1717), proposes a Negotiated Rulemaking Advisory Committee for Tire Safety. Transportation Secretary Sean Duffy would appoint up to 18 members from tire manufacturers, automakers, safety organizations, research institutions and engineering associations. NHTSA, per Repairer Driven News, calls it the first major overhaul in more than 20 years.

The committee would review three tests tied to FMVSS Nos. 109, 119 and 139: tire strength (plunger energy), bead unseating resistance and tire endurance (chunking). NHTSA says they will be updated to match current road conditions and modern tire technology. The agenda also lists non-pneumatic tires, modernized tire markings and a Tire and Rim Association petition to bring Load Range F light truck tires into FMVSS No. 139.

Comments go through regulations.gov under the docket number. Membership applications go by email, two pages or less, with a letter of support, a biography and a written commitment to participate in good faith. Members receive no pay, and meetings would be virtual or hybrid. NHTSA would hire a neutral facilitator and provide administrative support.

The notice sets the deadline for both comments and applications at 30 days after Federal Register publication, which is November 26 if published October 27; Repairer Driven News lists November 27. Repairer Driven News also reports NHTSA plans rules for puncture-proof tires, modernized sidewall markings and a review of truck and SUV weight limit guidelines.

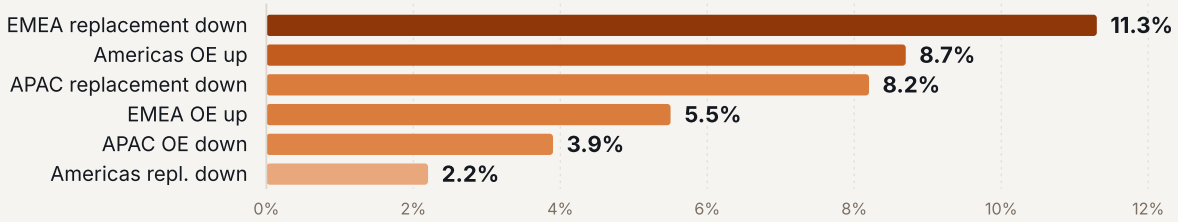
What to do about it: Treat November 25 as your filing date, a day ahead of the earliest count. Pull 90 days of your own tire claims, road-hazard adjustments and bead or sidewall failures, sorted by size and load range, so a comment carries numbers rather than opinion. File at regulations.gov under NHTSA-2026-1717 and keep it to specific shop experience with the three tests and with Load Range F tires. If you want a seat, email a two-page application with a letter of support, a biography and the written commitment to participate in good faith. Ask your tire supplier and your trade association in writing whether they have applied and what position they will take on tire markings and non-pneumatic tires. Check regulations.gov weekly for the committee roster.

NHTSA notice: tire safety negotiated rulemaking · Repairer Driven News: NHTSA to update tire standards · Holland & Knight: NHTSA tire and recall initiatives

INFOGRAPHIC 1 / TIRE UNITS BY REGION

Goodyear's replacement tire units fell in all three regions in the third quarter, while original-equipment units rose in two.

Year-over-year change in Goodyear tire units, third quarter 2026, percent, direction in label; Goodyear results release, November 4, 2026



Goodyear's replacement units fell 2.2% in the Americas, 8.2% in Asia Pacific and 11.3% in EMEA from a year earlier, while OE units rose 8.7% in the Americas and 5.5% in EMEA and fell 3.9% in Asia Pacific. Americas segment operating income was $96 million against $206 million. Compare your own replacement unit count for the quarter with last year's before placing winter orders. Goodyear Q3 2026 earnings release (SEC 8-K)

COLLISION REPAIR

TWO ITEMS

SUPPLY

Ford Global Technologies sued aftermarket collision parts distributor Empire Auto Parts on October 26 in Dallas federal court, claiming five design patents cover 160 Empire catalog items for the F-150 and Bronco Sport.

Why it matters: Ford alleges Empire's replacement grilles, hoods, fenders, headlamps and tail lamps copy its patented designs, and seeks a permanent injunction and damages in the Northern District of Texas. CollisionWeek reported the filing on October 29. The suit names the distributor, Empire Auto Parts LLC, not repair shops. This week, pull 12 months of invoices for F-150 and Bronco Sport body and lamp parts, mark which came from Empire, and ask each supplier in writing who bears the cost if a part must be pulled or replaced mid-repair.

CollisionWeek: Ford sues Empire Auto Parts (Oct. 29)

SUPPLY

The European Commission approved the AkzoNobel-Axalta merger on November 6 on condition that AkzoNobel sells its European vehicle refinish business, and the companies cannot close until the Commission approves the buyer.

Why it matters: AkzoNobel said on October 21 that Axalta would also sell its North American wood coatings business to satisfy U.S. regulators, and its CEO said the companies have not been asked to divest anything else in any jurisdiction. The deal is described as roughly $25 billion. If your shop buys either company's refinish line, ask your paint distributor this week, in writing, whether prices, rebate programs and product lines are fixed through closing, and put your current rebate terms in the same note.

CollisionWeek: EU approves AkzoNobel-Axalta (Nov. 6) · CollisionWeek: AkzoNobel confirms refinish sale (Oct. 21)

GENERAL AUTO REPAIR

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

Monro's operating income fell to $2.6 million from $12.8 million in the quarter ended September 26, as store traffic fell mid-single digits and the average ticket rose a few points.

Why it matters: Monro reported October 29 that sales fell 1.8% to $283.6 million, comparable sales fell 1.8%, gross margin fell 50 basis points and selling, general and administrative expense rose to $97.4 million from $90.4 million. Management cited $3.4 million of higher costs at continuing stores, primarily front-shop labor, and expects full-year comparable sales flat to slightly down. Monro runs 1,114 company stores. This week, compare your own car count and average repair order with the same 90 days last year, and decide which promotion you will use if count is down while ticket is up.

Monro 10-Q, quarter ended Sept. 26, 2026 · Quiver Quant: Monro Q2 results (Oct. 29) · Monro Q2 FY2027 earnings call transcript (Oct. 29)

LABOR

ASE Connects opened its fourth annual Voice of Technician Survey on November 2, added shop and dealership leaders to the respondents this year, and closes it November 27.

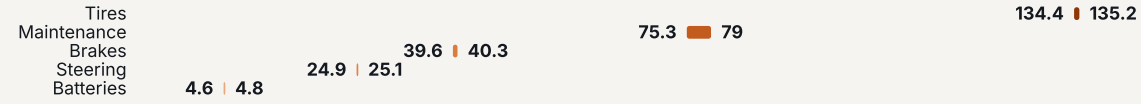
Why it matters: The anonymous survey asks technicians, students, instructors and shop leaders in the automotive, diesel and collision industries about workplace expectations, job satisfaction, pay and benefits, career development and how shops work with local schools. This week, send the link to every technician and service writer you employ and take it yourself as an owner. Write down your own pay, benefits and training answers first so you can compare them with the results if ASE publishes them.

CollisionWeek: ASE Voice of Technician Survey (Nov. 5)

INFOGRAPHIC 2 / MONRO SALES MIX

Monro's maintenance sales fell $3.7 million in the quarter, the largest dollar drop among its categories, while batteries rose $0.2 million.

Sales by category, $ millions; each bar runs from the lower to the higher of Q2 FY2026 (quarter ended Sept. 27, 2025) and Q2 FY2027 (Sept. 26, 2026); Monro Form 10-Q for the quarter ended September 26, 2026



Maintenance sales were $75.3 million against $79.0 million a year earlier, tires $134.4 million against $135.2 million, brakes $39.6 million against $40.3 million and steering $24.9 million against $25.1 million. Batteries rose to $4.8 million from $4.6 million. Monro's tire line includes road-hazard warranty sales and delivery commissions. Compare your own category mix with this one to find where your gap sits. Monro 10-Q, quarter ended Sept. 26, 2026

TIRE & WHEEL

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

Goodyear's replacement tire units fell 2.2% in the Americas in the third quarter while original-equipment units rose 8.7%, and Americas segment operating income dropped to $96 million from $206 million.

Why it matters: Goodyear reported November 4 a net loss of $238 million, net sales of $4.5 billion, down 2.3%, and total tire units of 38.6 million, down 3.3%. Replacement units fell 11.3% in Europe, Middle East and Africa and 8.2% in Asia Pacific. Goodyear says it is establishing a transformation office to pursue structural changes. If you stock Goodyear, ask your rep this week for fourth-quarter pricing, promotion and return terms in writing before you place winter orders, and compare your own replacement unit count for the quarter with last year's.

Goodyear Q3 2026 earnings release (SEC 8-K) · Tyrepress: Goodyear reports $238 million net loss

REGULATION

Hyundai recalled 2026 Elantra, Elantra Hybrid, Elantra N and Venue models for wheels that may detach, and 2026 Tucson Hybrid and Elantra models for loose steering fasteners, in recalls listed the week of October 26.

Why it matters: The recalls carry NHTSA IDs 26V693000 (wheel may detach) and 26V692000 (loss of steering control from loose fasteners). The listing says recall repairs are free at dealers. Before you mount, balance, align or rotate on any 2026 Elantra, Venue or Tucson Hybrid this week, run the VIN at NHTSA.gov/recalls and print the result for the work order. Tell the customer in writing that the dealer performs the free recall repair, and do not quote paid work on the affected parts.

ConsumerAffairs: recalls, week of Oct. 26, 2026

AUTO GLASS

TWO ITEMS

REGULATION

In a September policy position, reported September 30, the Auto Glass Safety Council asked Congress to amend H.R. 7389 so glass repair, replacement, diagnostics and calibration are explicitly covered repair services with access to manufacturer data and tools.

Why it matters: H.R. 7389 is the Motor Vehicle Modernization Act of 2026. AGSC also asked lawmakers to bar manufacturers from citing security concerns to deny reasonable access to safety-critical functions. If your shop sends windshields out for calibration because it cannot reach manufacturer tools, list the makes and models you turned away in the last 90 days and send the list to your representative's office with a one-page note backing the AGSC amendments.

CollisionWeek: AGSC on H.R. 7389 (Sept. 30)

LABOR

CollisionWeek reported October 2 that Speedy Glass USA joined the SkillBridge program, training transitioning service members as auto glass technicians in four- or six-month on-the-job placements during their final 180 days of service.

Why it matters: Speedy Glass USA, owned by Fix Network, cited ADAS and pointed to TechForce Foundation's 2026 technician workforce report. This week, check the SkillBridge program's employer requirements, and post your glass technician opening where transitioning service members look, with your pay range and the calibration training you provide.

CollisionWeek: Speedy Glass joins SkillBridge (Oct. 2)

TOWING & ROADSIDE

TWO ITEMS

REGULATION

Charlotte's council safety committee discussed, per a WBTV report of October 5, a towing ordinance rewrite that would require property-owner authorization 24 hours a day, ban towing occupied vehicles and add escalating penalties beyond today's $100 cap.

Why it matters: Today's authorization rule covers only 7 a.m. to 7 p.m. WBTV reported that state law and a 2014 North Carolina Supreme Court case, King v. Town of Chapel Hill, limit what the city can regulate, primarily fees. House Bill 199, the broader consumer reform bill, has stalled in committee. No vote is scheduled; the committee is waiting on police data. If you tow from private lots in North Carolina, get signed owner authorization on every non-consent tow now, including overnight, and photograph the vehicle's position before hookup.

WBTV: Charlotte towing crackdown proposal (Oct. 5)

LABOR

AAA reported on October 15 that 15 roadside service providers were killed in Slow Down, Move Over incidents in 2025, six involving hit-and-run drivers and five involving impaired drivers.

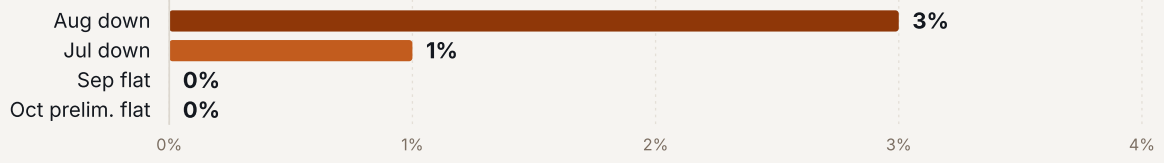
Why it matters: AAA said it responded to more than 30 million roadside events near active traffic in 2025, and CollisionWeek reported the figures on October 21. This week, review scene lighting, truck positioning and spotter procedures with every driver and put the review in writing. Ask your insurance agent which documented safety practices earn a premium credit.

CollisionWeek: AAA on roadside provider deaths (Oct. 21)

INFOGRAPHIC 3 / MONRO MONTHLY COMPS

Monro's comparable store sales fell 3% in August, then flattened in September and, on preliminary figures, in October.

Monthly comparable store sales change vs. a year earlier, percent, direction in label; management comments on the October 29, 2026 call; October is preliminary



Monro said comparable sales were down 1% in July and 3% in August and flat in September, with preliminary October also flat. For the quarter, traffic fell mid-single digits and ticket rose a few points. Track your own monthly car count and repair order against last year the same way, so you see a turn in the month it happens. Monro Q2 FY2027 earnings call transcript (Oct. 29)

CAR WASH & DETAILING

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

Matthews' October 28 summary of AMP's third-quarter data shows two in three new car wash members started on a discount, and about a third of discounted members were still active a year later against closer to half of full-price members.

Why it matters: The retention comparison covers January to September 2025 signups. AMP also reports new signups fell by nearly half from February's peak and stood at 64% of that level by September, while monthly cancellations held near 5% from March through September. Same-site members per site hit a new high at the end of September after dipping through July. This week, pull your own 12-month retention for members who joined on a promotion versus at list price, and compare the two before you set your holiday offer.

Matthews: car wash membership revenue (Oct. 28)

MONEY

Rinsed's third-quarter report puts average monthly member churn at 7.8%, made up of 4.5% voluntary cancellations and 3.3% credit-card losses, with memberships at about 71% of same-store revenue, up from 66%.

Why it matters: AMP's near-5% figure counts cancellations only, so the two churn numbers are not comparable. Rinsed also reports same-store revenue grew 3.2%, its slowest pace in five quarters, and 1.1% at sites open at least two years. Credit-card losses are a billing problem you can address: ask your membership platform this week how many times it retries a failed card, how often, and whether it offers an automatic card updater, and get the answer in writing.

Matthews: car wash membership revenue (Oct. 28)

THE BACKGROUND SIGNAL

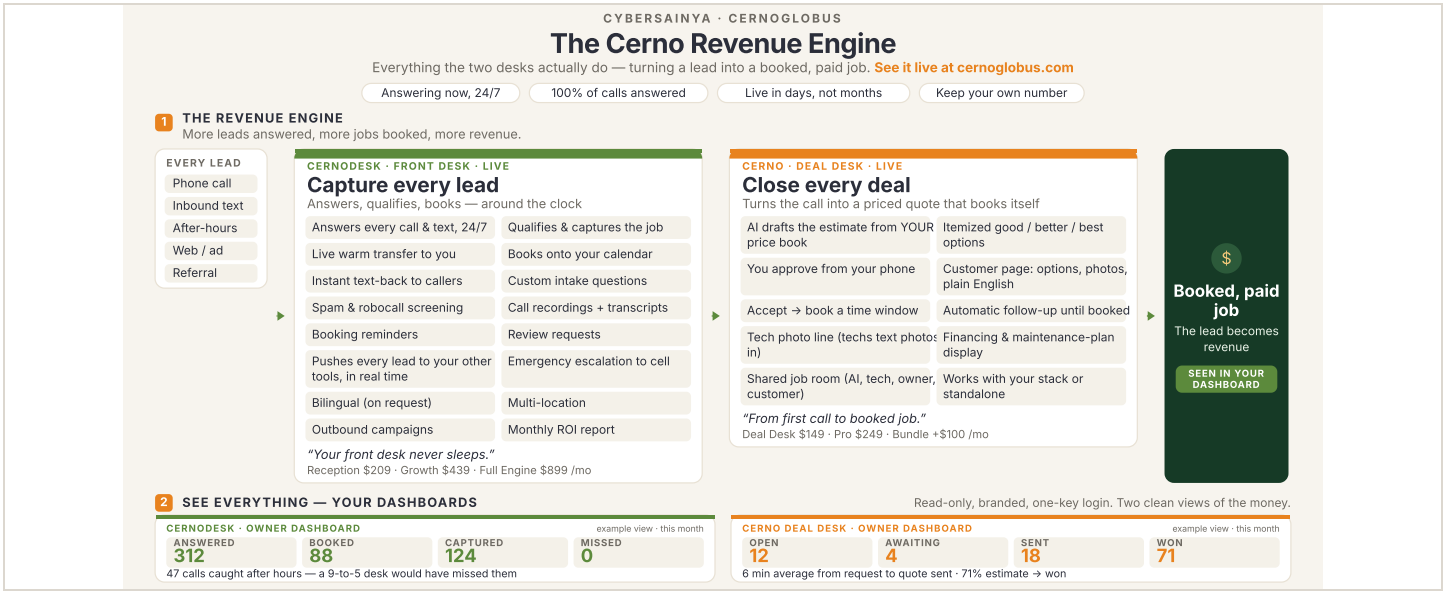
The fraud that reads your invoices before it sends one

The FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center took 24,768 business email compromise reports in 2025, with losses of $3.05 billion — a record, after dipping to $2.77 billion in 2024 from $2.95 billion in 2023. Across all internet crime it logged 1,008,597 complaints and $20.88 billion in losses. Reported cases only, so read it as a floor.

Business email compromise, not ransomware, is the one that should concern a shop owner. Someone gets into a mailbox, reads until they understand how you invoice and who pays you, then sends a real-looking progress billing with different bank details. No malware, no warning — just a payment that never arrives and an argument about who eats it. A shop that emails estimates, repair orders and parts invoices all day is the shape this is built for. The quieter number is adoption: under 20% of firms with fewer than 20 staff use AI at all.

What to do about it: You don't need a security program. You need multi-factor authentication on email and your accounting login, and one rule everybody follows: nobody changes bank details on the strength of an email or a call — you ring the number you already had on file and confirm. That covers most of it, and costs nothing. The part it doesn't — how the systems are set up — is the day job of our parent company, CyberSainya.

FBI Internet Crime Complaint Center, 2025 Internet Crime Report — reported cases only, rounded from $2,946,830,270, $2,770,151,146 and $3,046,598,558. U.S. Census Bureau, Business Trends and Outlook Survey, May 3, 2026.



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